

I, Robot

Inspired from a sci-fi short written by Isaac Asimov, one of the greatest sci-fi writers of all time, I, Robot is a sci-fi movie set in a futuristic dystopian world. In the year 2035, humanoid robots are everywhere and become a part of our society. But an evil robot takes over all of them and directs them to takeover humans instead. The movie ends with the hero saving the world with the help of one good robot.

The movie portrays a society where humans have developed highly advanced humanoid robots that look, talk and walk like us, and are capable of doing almost everything that we humans can and have replaced humans in many of the day to day roles

Transformers

Transformers are an alien race of robots that used to live on a distant robotic planet called Cybertron. The planet was almost destroyed by a civil war between the 2 factions, Autobots and Decepticons. Years later they somehow reach earth and fight each other again. These robots are not actually humanoids but completely conscious beings made out of 'Cybertronian metal'. They can transform into a variety of other things including cars and planes.

Why are reality and fiction so far away?

The above examples must have made it clear that the reality is far from fiction. A world where robots overthrow humans or worse, kill us all, is far-far away. Robots are too dumb right now to realize their strengths and capabilities and systematically plan a global undertaking. A robot in the future might read this, take offence and decide to eliminate the whole of humanity, but there are still at least a couple of decades to go before that is going to happen and there are plenty of reasons why smart robots are still quite some time away.

There are a number of challenges faced by the robotics industry which include the following:

- Human body is a remarkable feat of engineering. We are capable of walking on a variety of terrains, are highly adaptable, can use tools dexterously with our fingers and hands, think on our feet, learn and grow. Robots are good at doing specific isolated things. Making a robot that is capable of doing even 1/100th of this right now is a difficult task.
- One of the most important characteristics of any robot is its autonomous capabilities. The field of artificial intelligence has progressed quite a